



Assignment - 1 : Reflection

For CSCE 679 - Data Visualization

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Reflection on How ChatGPT Helped Me

AI was especially helpful in guiding me through the structure of the D3 visualization. Since this was my first time building a matrix-style chart with interactive features, I initially struggled to understand how to organize the layout using scales and grouped data. AI helped me break the problem into smaller parts: parsing the CSV, grouping by year and month, building the matrix grid, and then adding interactions step by step.

One of the most valuable contributions was explaining how D3 selections and scales work together. Instead of copying code blindly, I was able to understand why we use `scaleBand` for positioning, `scaleSequential` for color encoding, and how to dynamically update attributes when toggling between monthly max and min values.

AI was also helpful in debugging. When I encountered Git errors, remote conflicts, and push issues, AI explained what the errors meant and why they occurred. This improved my understanding of Git branches and remotes rather than just giving me commands to run.

Overall, AI acted as a learning assistant and debugging partner. I still had to test each interaction, verify visual outputs, and ensure the implementation matched the assignment requirements. The final result reflects both AI guidance and my own understanding developed through iteration and testing.
